

Tulip Time Festival

Michigan

This festival is held in cities that were founded by the Dutch or had large numbers of Dutch settlers. Tulips line the streets and special tulip gardens are created for the event.

Thanksgiving

US and Canada

This harvest celebration in November (October in Canada) usually involves a turkey dinner. It was first held to give thanks for the harvest of 1621.

Noche de Rábanos

Oaxaca, Mexico

When radishes first were brought to the Americas in the 16th century, market traders made radish sculptures to advertise the new vegetables. The "Night of the Radishes" has celebrated that custom since 1897.

Tapati Festival

Easter Island

Tapati includes dancing, ritual chants, art exhibits, carving competitions, horse and boat races, body-painting, a string figure (*kai-kai*) contest, the selection of a queen, a parade, and *haka pei*—sliding down a steep hillside on banana-tree trunks at high speed.

Inti Raymi Day

Cuzco, Peru

The Festival of the Sun dates back to the Incas. People celebrate the winter solstice and the start of the new year.

Cheese Rolling Festival

Gloucestershire, UK

Contestants chase a wheel of cheese down a steep, muddy hill.

Tomatina

Buñol, Valencia

Since 1944, tomato fights have been held on the last Wednesday of August. More than 110 tons of tomatoes are hurled each year!

Festival of the Sahara

Tunisia

A festival celebrating nomadic life and traditions. Events include camel marathons and performances of Bedouin song, dance, and poetry.

Festival-au-Desert

Mali

Three days of traditional Tuareg art, music, and dance. Everyone camps in the desert, with their camels close by.

Carnival

Carnival is marked by parades, such as in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil (left). It comes just before Lent—a time of fasting and avoiding rich foods that leads up to the Christian festival of Easter.



Major Carnival locations



Festivals

Festivals give people a chance to celebrate their religious and cultural traditions. Above all, they are a great opportunity to throw a party!